## Set D – Strong contention or not yet?

- *With a partner: sort each card under a heading.*
- *For each "not yet" card, explain what is missing.*

| **Strong contention** *Set D* | **Not a contention yet** *Set D* | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Year 7 students should be allowed to wear sports uniform every day. *Set D* | Social media is bad. *Set D* | Under-16s should not be allowed to have social media accounts. *Set D* | Is lunchtime too short? *Set D* |
| Some people like homework and some people don't. *Set D* | Lots of students have phones. *Set D* | Schools should not set homework over the holidays. *Set D* | Lunchtime should be 20 minutes longer. *Set D* |
| Gambling on sports. *Set D* | I want to be able to use social media. *Set D* | The AFL must stop changing its rules every year. *Set D* | I love books. *Set D* |

## Set E – Video games

*With a partner: sort the cards under the four headings. Then build each argument: put each contention under its issue, and place the two claims that support it underneath.*

| Topic | Issue | Contention | Claim |
|---|---|---|---|
| *Set E* | *Set E* | *Set E* | *Set E* |
| Students who game for hours have less time for homework and reading. *Set E* | Gaming should be limited to one hour on school nights. *Set E* | Young children often copy what they see on screen. *Set E* | Parents, not the government, should decide which games their children play. *Set E* |
| Age ratings on violent games should be strictly enforced. *Set E* | Gaming can help students relax after a stressful school day. *Set E* | Parents know their own children better than any government does. *Set E* | Video games *Set E* |
| The impact of video games on learning. *Set E* | Online gaming is how many teenagers stay connected with their friends. *Set E* | Violent games played by young children *Set E* | Strict time limits on gaming are not needed on school nights. *Set E* |
| Gaming late at night stops students from getting enough sleep. *Set E* | Violent games can give young children nightmares and make them anxious. *Set E* | Many parents play games with their children and can talk about what they see. *Set E* | |

# Teacher answer key

*06.1c – Contention card sorts*

## How to run it

Set D comes earlier in the lesson, after you explain the strong contention checklist: it takes a side, it is specific, and it is a statement, not a question.

Set E comes after students have found Eleni Paneras' claims (06.1w Part 3) and before they write their own (Part 4). Pairs sort the cards under four headings (Topic, Issue, Contention, Claim), then build four mini-arguments: issue, then contention, then two claims. Each issue has one contention for and one against, which reinforces that a strong contention takes a side. If time is short, give each pair one issue only (7 cards).

## Set D – Strong contention or not yet?

**Strong contentions:**

- Under-16s should not be allowed to have social media accounts.
- Schools should not set homework over the holidays.
- Lunchtime should be 20 minutes longer.
- Year 7 students should be allowed to wear sports uniform every day.

**Not a contention yet:**

- "Social media is bad." → too vague: bad how? What should happen?
- "Lots of students have phones." → a fact, not a position
- "Some people like homework and some people don't." → sits on the fence
- "Is lunchtime too short?" → a question, not a statement

## Set E – Video games

- Topic: Video games
- Issues: Violent games played by young children | Hours spent gaming on school nights
- **"Age ratings on violent games should be strictly enforced, online and in stores."** → violent games / for stricter rules
  - Claim: Young children often copy what they see on screen.
  - Claim: Violent games can give young children nightmares and make them anxious.
- **"Parents, not the government, should decide which games their children play."** → violent games / against stricter rules
  - Claim: Parents know their own children better than any government does.
  - Claim: Many parents play games with their children and can talk about what they see.
- **"Gaming should be limited to one hour on school nights."** → school nights / for limits
  - Claim: Gaming late at night stops students from getting enough sleep.
  - Claim: Students who game for hours have less time for homework and reading.
- **"Strict time limits on gaming are not needed on school nights."** → school nights / against limits
  - Claim: Online gaming is how many teenagers stay connected with their friends.
  - Claim: Gaming can help students relax after a stressful school day.